

SOFTWARE DESIGN (YAZILIM TASARIMI)

Week 5

Principles of (General) Design

- *Design emerges from a **need** to solve a problem.*
- *Design is a **creative** process to meet the need to solve the problem.*
- *Design has two phases:*
 - ***Inspiration** phase*
 - ***Expression** or **communication** phase.*
- *Design – as applied by nature – is a **bottom-up** process.*

Design: Inspiration Phase

- *The original (i.e., inspired) idea or thought is **disordered** or **chaotic**.*
- *It is **not expressible/communicable** as inspired.*
- *A powerful communication basis is required to **express** the inspired thought(s) in an organized manner.*

Design: Communication Phase

- *Idea or thought is disorganized as inspired.*
- *Words form a tool to communicate inspired thoughts.*
- *Words are components to express/communicate thoughts in a comprehensible manner.*
- *Designer is not confined in her inspirations; but restricted to the expressive power of the words she selects to communicate her thought(s).*
- *The quality of the communicated thought depends upon the **expressive power of the words** and the **potential of the designer to use words**.*

Conclusion from Last Page

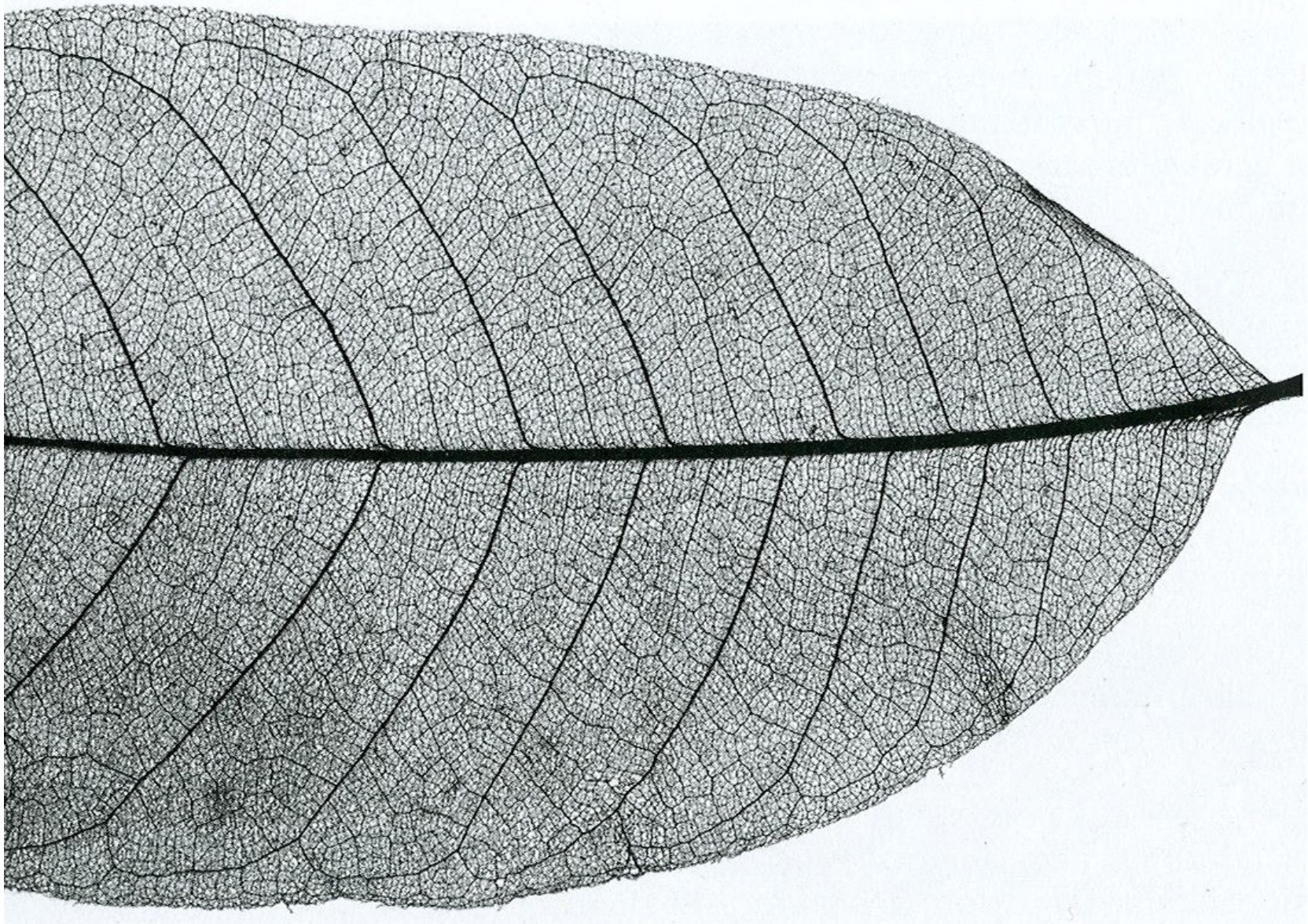
It is inevitable that the designer should have a well-established basis of knowledge on the set of communication tool(s) to use them to her best.

Nature's Tradition of Perfect Design

- *Nature's designs are fit since nature bases its designs upon the (to a significant extent unknown) internal reasons originating from an incredible level of balance in an enourmously diverse system of adaptable (evolving) organisms.*

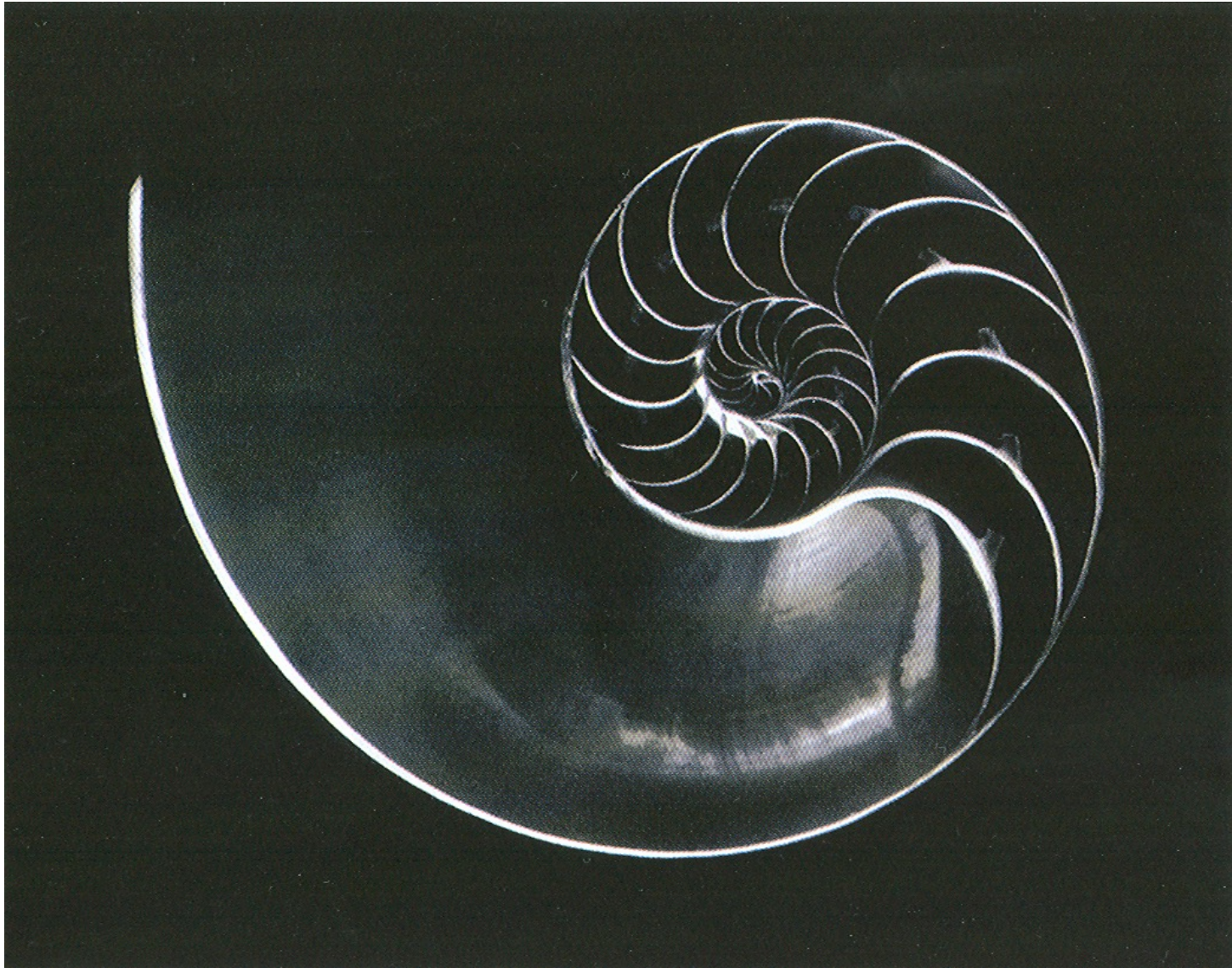
Nature's Multi-Levelled Approach to Design

- *Nature has evolved the tiger to do whatever it achieves to survive in its environment; through **evolution** nature has excelled its design (i.e., all aspects ranging from its most detailed **cellular** to most general **systemic** level) to progressively fit its environment.*
- *The same is valid for a leaf or a snail or us.*



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Nature Designs in a Bottom-up Fashion!

- *Nature's way of design ranging from the most detailed **cellular** to most general **systemic** level to provide an organism with all necessary and sufficient properties to survive its current environment is explained by its **bottom-up** approach to design along with its equipping these organisms with evolvability.*

Means of SW Design

- *UML*
- *Prototyping language (if required)*
- *Formal Language, corresponding IDE*
- *Environment: O/S, hardware, network.*
- *Graphic tools (if necessary)*
- *Others?*

SW Design: A Top-Down & Bottom-up Process

- *Designer is required to establish a sufficient background on all tools employed in any part of SW design.*
- *Establishing the required level of background on tools of use, the designer naturally follows a bottom-up approach to SW design.*
- *Time (tens of millions of years) that nature has for design is what SW designer does not. Hence, top-down approach is an option as a structuring approach to design in scarcity of time.*

Key Points

- Look for *solutions as simple as possible*;
- Nature's choice is also for as simple/optimal as can be. We appreciate this fact from our everyday experience on living organisms that they have the simplest necessary equipment for the given functionality;
- Remember! Among a number of solution alternatives to a problem, *the best one is the simplest one! (Occam's razor!)*;

Key Points

- *Learn all necessary means of SW design (i.e., those we have considered on page 11) to your best and expand your experience on using them;*
- *Just as one who possesses a large vocabulary and is talented (and/or educated) to use words meaningfully and correctly can more powerfully express her/his thoughts than an ordinary person, a SW engineer well equipped with/experienced on necessary tools is more likely to come up with better SW designs in general.*

Quiz 2 - 25/3/2026 (5 minutes)

Do not forget your: Name+Surname, Student ID, Signature, Date

1. What are the two phases of design?
2. Name at least two levels the nature designs in its multi-levelled approach?
3. Nature designs in a bottom-up manner.
Why is the top-down design approach a good option for SW designer?

Architectural Design

Architectural Design

- ... is the design stage for identifying
 - the *sub-systems* making up a system and
 - the framework for sub-system *control and communication*.

Architectural design ...2

- an *early stage* of the *system design*.
- a *link* between *specification* and *design*.
- ... involves *identifying major system components and their communications*.
- especially *cost-effective* for *large scale systems*.

Advantages of explicit architecture

- ***Stakeholder communication***
 - a *focus of discussion* by system stakeholders.
- ***System analysis***
 - Architectural design at an early stage requires system analysis. This in turn makes analysis possible of *whether the system can meet its non-functional requirements*.
- ***Large-scale reuse***
 - architecture reusable?

Architecture and system characteristics

- *Performance*
 - Localise critical operations and minimise communications. Use larger rather than finer components.
- *Security*
 - Use layered architecture with critical assets in the inner layers.
- *Safety*
 - Localise safety-critical features in a small number of sub-systems.
- *Availability*
 - Include redundant components and mechanisms for fault tolerance.
- *Maintainability*
 - Use finer, replaceable components.

Architectural conflicts

- A *high performance and maintainable* system?
- *Availability* (i.e., redundant data, failover (iş üstlenme) mechanisms) and *security* (i.e., layered architecture, access restrictions, additional layers for authentication) together?
- A *safe* (safety-related features means more communication) and *high performance* system?

Ex: Core trade-off between maintainability and performance

Maintainability Decision	Impact on Performance
<i>Modularization (e.g., microservices, layered architecture)</i>	<i>Increased communication overhead</i>
<i>Abstraction layers (interfaces & design patterns)</i>	<i>Additional indirection and runtime overhead</i>
<i>High-level framework use</i>	<i>Reduced low-level control, potential inefficiencies</i>
<i>Readable and generalized code</i>	<i>Less optimized, may sacrifice performance for clarity</i>
<i>Extensive logging and instrumentation</i>	<i>Increased I/O overhead and latency</i>

Ex: Core trade-off between maintainability and performance

Performance Decision	Impact on Maintainability
<i>Low level optimizations (e.g., memory tuning, bit-level operations)</i>	<i>Reduced readability and harder to understand code</i>
<i>Tight coupling/monolithic optimizations</i>	<i>Harder to modify, test and extend</i>
<i>Minimizing abstractions</i>	<i>Loss of modularity and reusability</i>
<i>Aggressive caching strategies</i>	<i>Added complexity in consistency and invalidation logic</i>

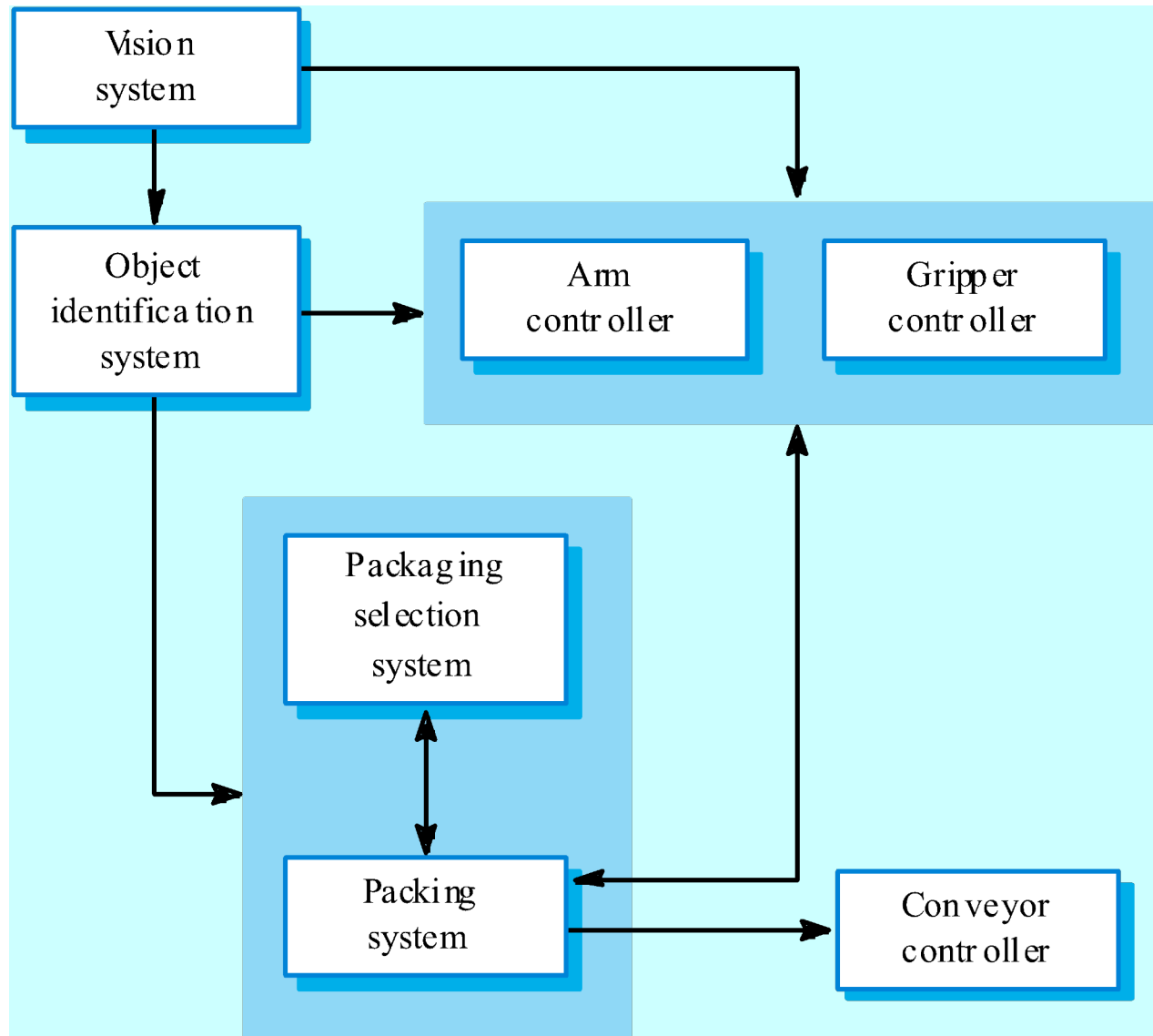
Ex: Core trade-off between availability and security

Availability Decision	Impact on Security
<i>Data replication (redundancy)</i>	<i>Increased risk of data exposure</i>
<i>Fast failover mechanisms</i>	<i>Potential weakening or bypassing of security controls</i>
<i>Distributed architecture</i>	<i>Expanded attack surface</i>
<i>Flexible access policies</i>	<i>Higher risk of unauthorized access</i>
Security Decision	Impact on Availability
<i>Multi-layered security</i>	<i>Increased latency and additional points of failure</i>
<i>Strict access control mechanisms</i>	<i>Potential blockage of legitimate users</i>
<i>Strong authentication requirements</i>	<i>Complications and slower responses in failover processes</i>
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24	

System structuring

- decomposing the system *into interacting sub-systems*.
- normally expressed as a *block diagram* presenting an overview of the system structure.
- showing how sub-systems
 - *share data,*
 - *are distributed and*
 - *interface with each other.*

Packing robot control system



Architectural design decisions

- Is there a generic application architecture that can be used?
- How will the system be distributed?
- What architectural styles are appropriate?
- What approach will be used to structure the system?
- How will the system be decomposed into modules?
- What control strategy should be used?
- How will the architectural design be evaluated?
- How should the architecture be documented?

Quiz – 31/3/2026 (5 minutes)

Do not forget your: Name+Surname, Student ID, Signature, Date

1. What are the advantages of explicit architecture?
2. Name at least five SW properties that may cause architectural conflicts!
3. Name at least two architectural conflicts that may arise in a design putting importance to SW properties in Q2 above!

Architectural models

- *Static structural model* that shows the major system components.
- *Dynamic process model* that shows the process structure of the system.
- *Interface model* that defines sub-system interfaces.
- *Relationships model* such as a data-flow model that shows sub-system relationships.
- *Distribution model* that shows how sub-systems are distributed across computers.

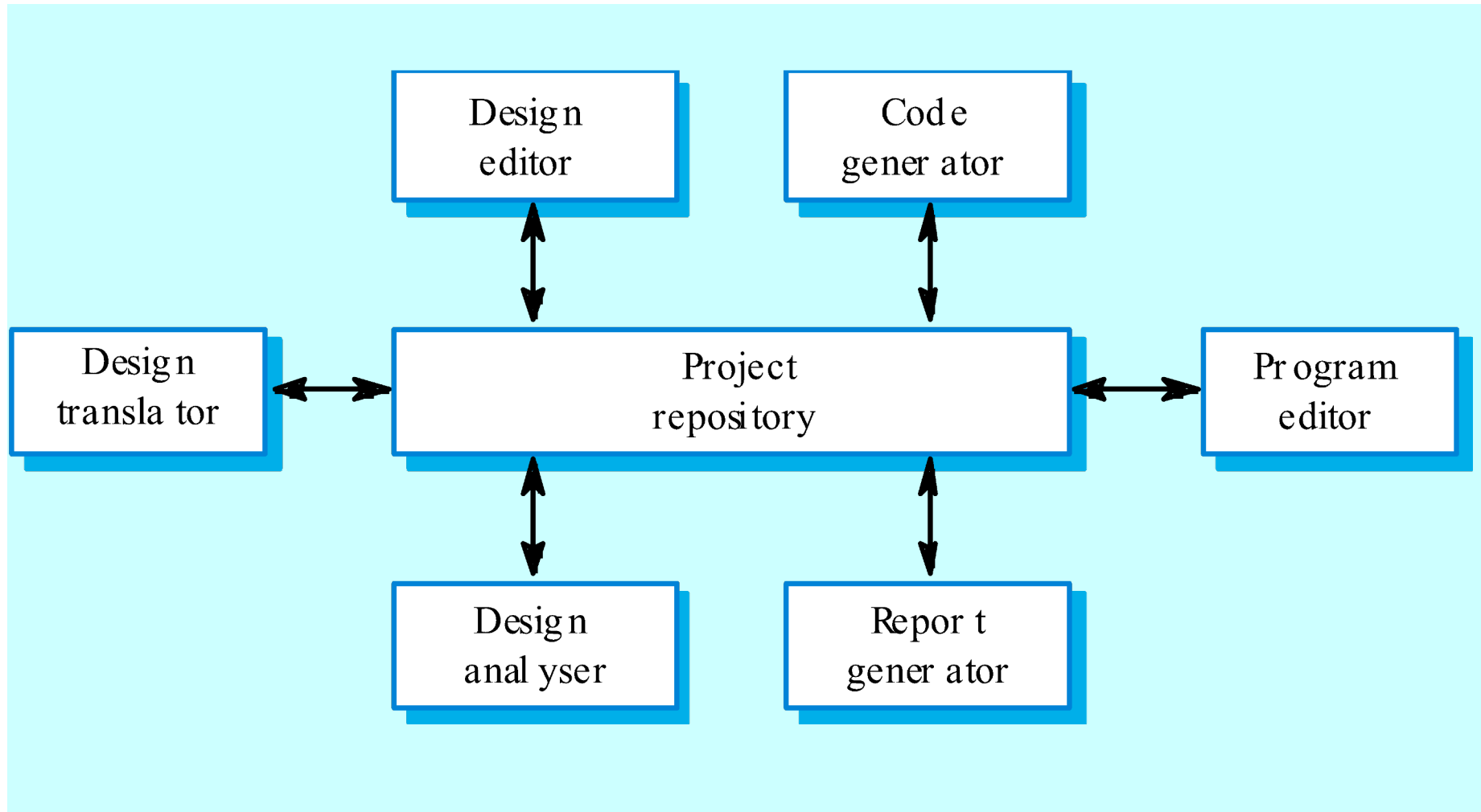
System organisation

- Reflects the basic strategy that is used to structure a system into its subsystems.
- Three organisational styles are widely used:
 - A *shared data repository* style;
 - A *shared services and servers* style;
 - An *abstract machine or layered* style.

The repository model

- Sub-systems exchange data in two ways:
 - *Shared data is held in a central database or repository* and may be accessed by all sub-systems;
 - *Each sub-system maintains its own database and passes data explicitly to other sub-systems.*
- When *large amounts of data* are to be shared, the *repository model* of sharing is most commonly used.

CASE toolset architecture



Repository model characteristics

- *Advantages*

- Efficient way to share large amounts of data;
- Sub-systems need not be concerned with how data is produced
- Centralised management e.g. backup, security, etc.

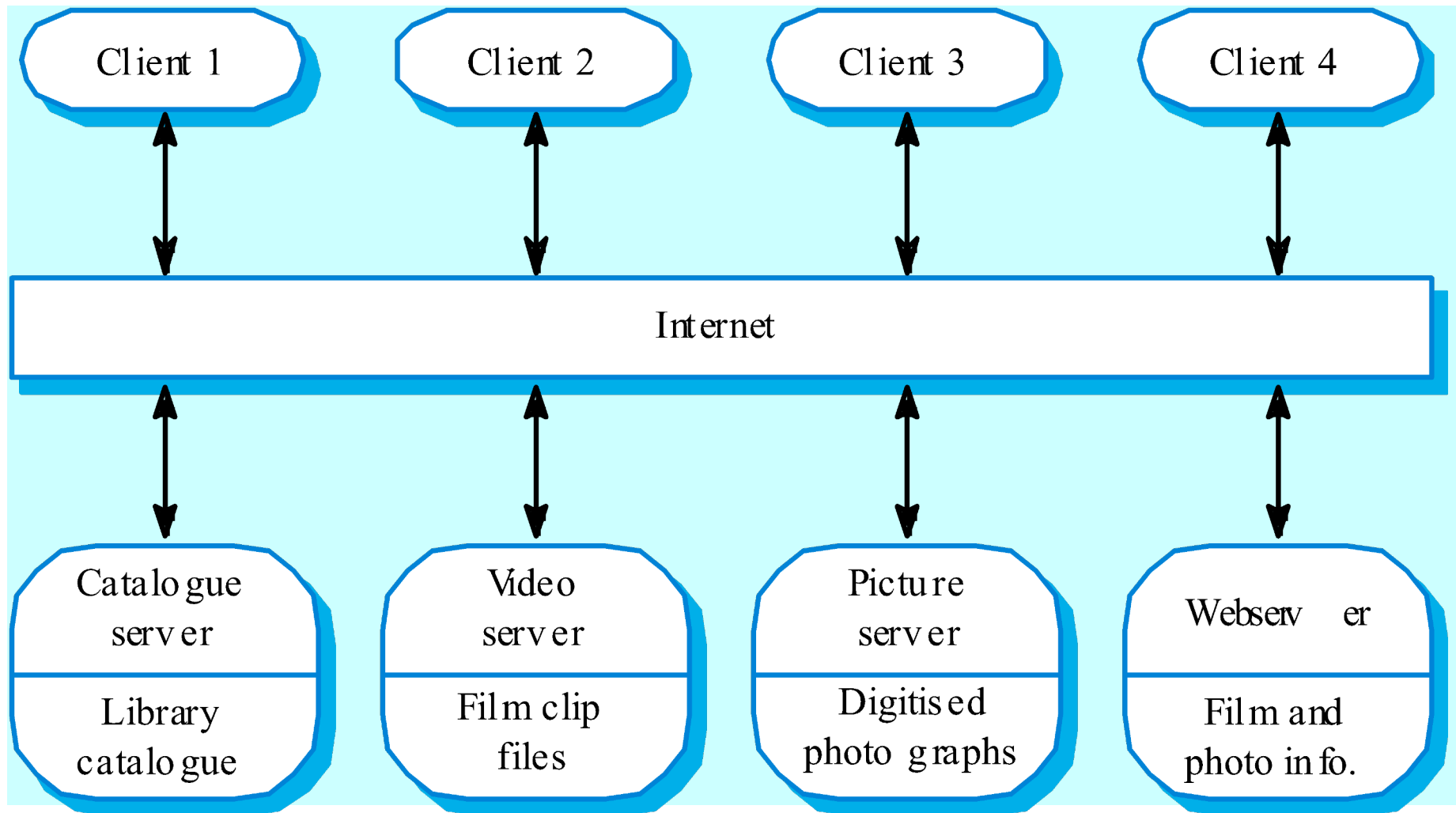
- *Disadvantages*

- Sub-systems must agree on a repository data model. Inevitably a compromise;
- Data evolution is difficult and expensive;
- Difficult to distribute efficiently.

Client-server model

- Distributed system model which shows *how data and processing is distributed across a range of components*.
- *Set of stand-alone servers* which provide specific services such as printing, data management, etc.
- *Set of clients* which request for these services.
- Network which allows clients to access servers.

Film and picture library



Client-server characteristics

- *Advantages*

- Distribution of data is straightforward;
- Makes effective use of networked systems. May require cheaper hardware;
- Easy to add new servers or upgrade existing servers.

- *Disadvantages*

- No shared data model so sub-systems use different data organisation. Data interchange may be inefficient;
- Redundant management in each server;
- No central register of names and services - it may be hard to find out what servers and services are available.

Abstract machine (layered) model

- Used to *model the interfacing of sub-systems*.
- Organises the *system into a set of layers* (or abstract machines) each of which provide *a set of services*.
- Supports the *incremental development* of sub-systems in different layers. When a layer interface changes, only the adjacent layer is affected.
- However, often artificial to structure systems in this way.

Modular decomposition styles

- Styles of *decomposing sub-systems into modules*.
- No rigid distinction between system organisation and modular decomposition.

Sub-systems and modules

- A *sub-system* is a system in its own right whose operation is *independent* of the services provided by other sub-systems.
- A *module* is a system component that provides services to other components but would *not* normally be considered as a *separate* system.

Modular decomposition

- Two modular decomposition models covered
 - An *object model* where the system is decomposed into interacting objects;
 - A pipeline or data-flow model where the system is decomposed into *functional modules* which transform inputs to outputs.
- If possible, decisions about concurrency should be delayed until modules are implemented.

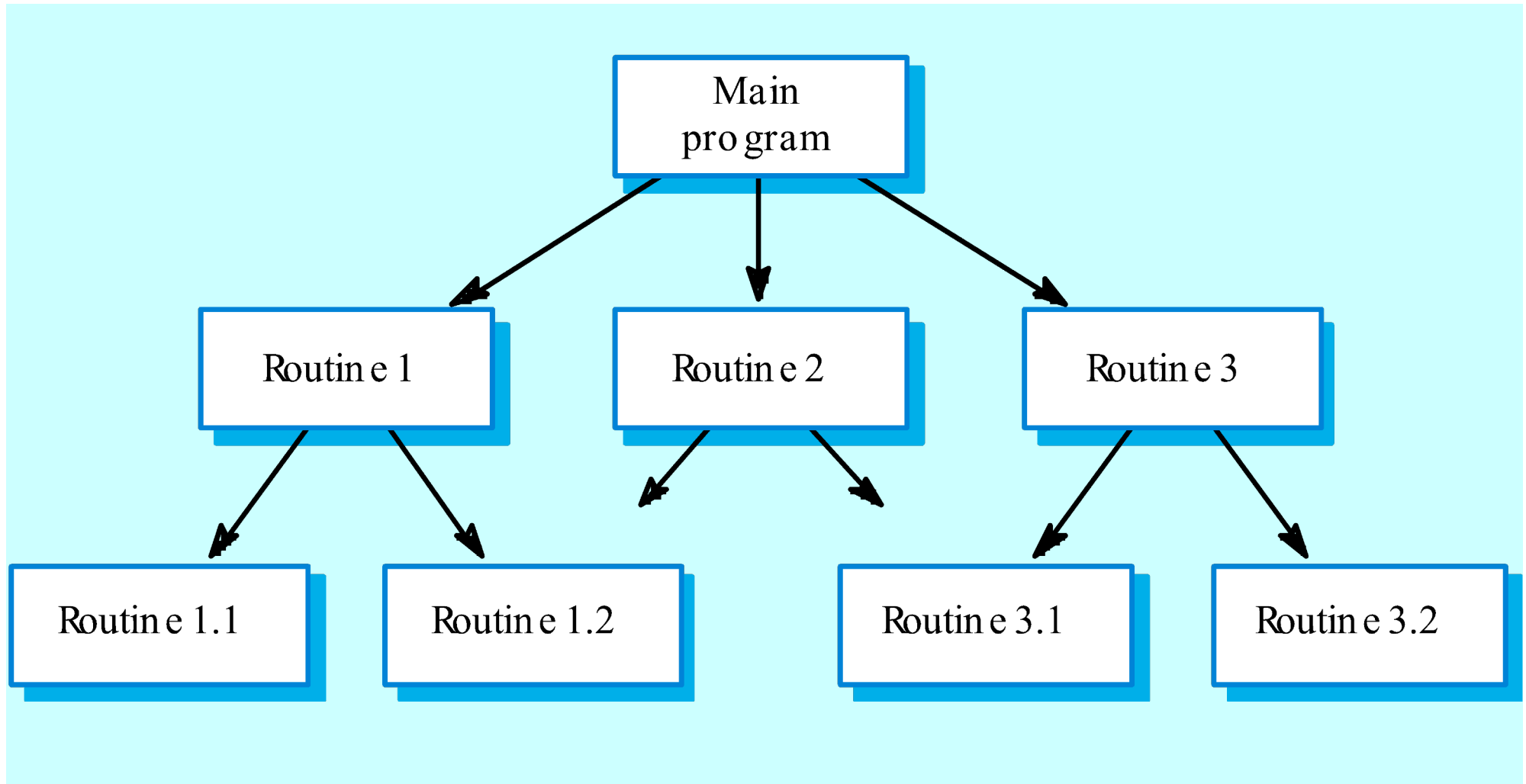
Control styles

- Ways of the control flow between sub-systems. Two ways:
 - *Centralised control*
 - *Event-based control*

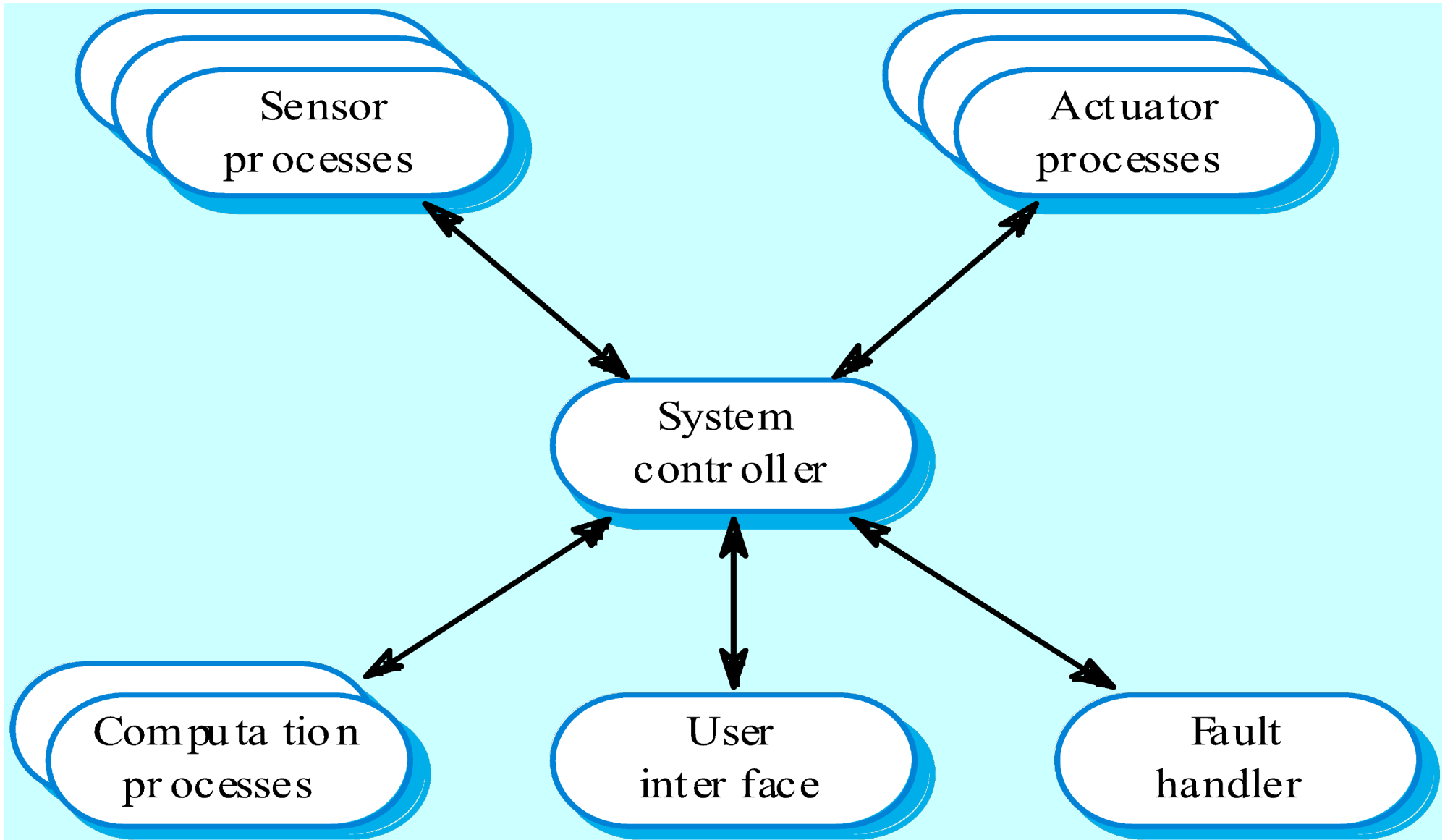
Centralised control

- A control sub-system takes responsibility for managing the execution of other sub-systems.
- *Call-return model*
 - Top-down subroutine model
 - Control starts at the root of a subroutine tree and moves downwards.
 - Applicable to sequential systems.
- *Manager model*
 - Applicable to concurrent systems.
 - One system component coordinates other system processes.

Call-return model



Real-time system control



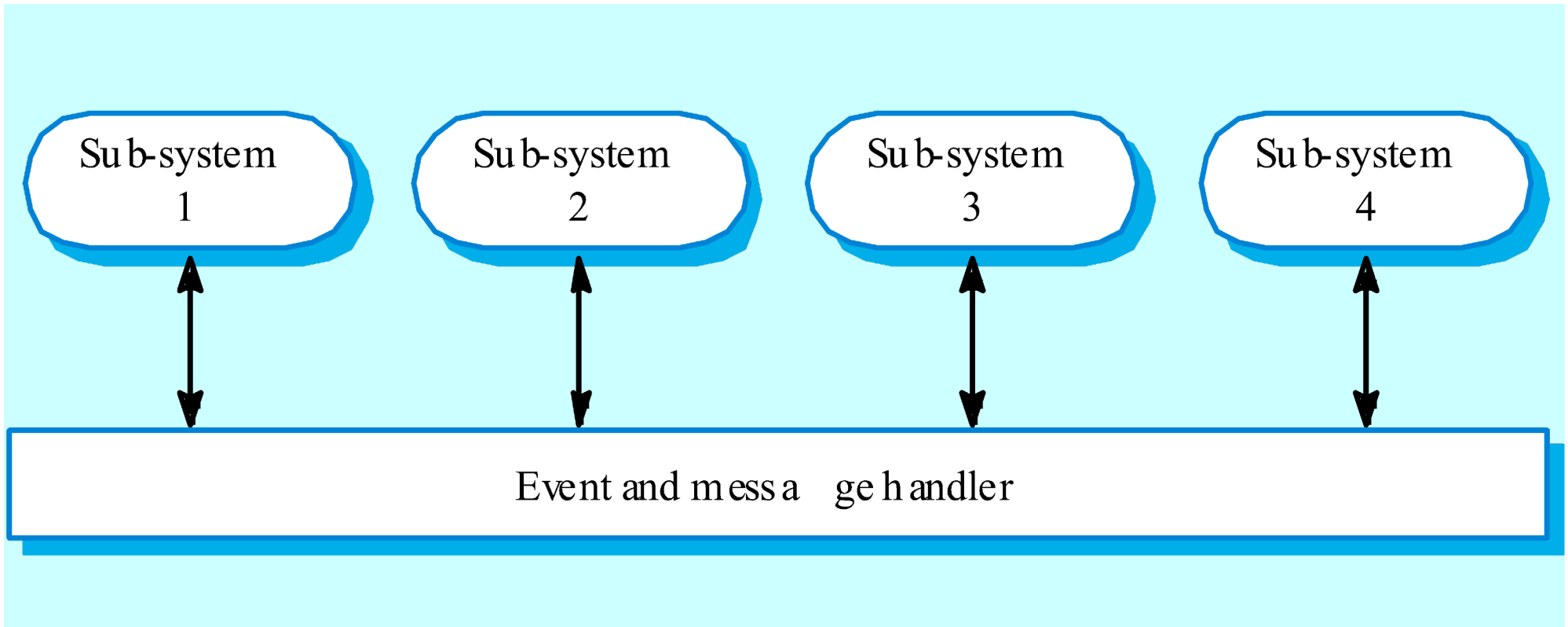
Event-driven systems

- The control of the sub-systems processing the event is driven by externally generated events
- Two primary event-driven models
 - **Broadcast models**. *An event is broadcast to all sub-systems. Any sub-system which can handle the event may do so;*
 - **Interrupt-driven models**. *Used in real-time systems where interrupts are detected by an interrupt handler and passed to some other component for processing.*
- Other event driven models include spreadsheets and production systems.

Broadcast model

- Effective in *integrating sub-systems on different computers* in a network.
- *Sub-systems register* an interest in specific events. When these occur, control is transferred to the sub-system which can handle the event.
- Control policy is not embedded in the event and message handler. Sub-systems decide on events of interest to them.
- However, sub-systems don't know if or when an event will be handled.

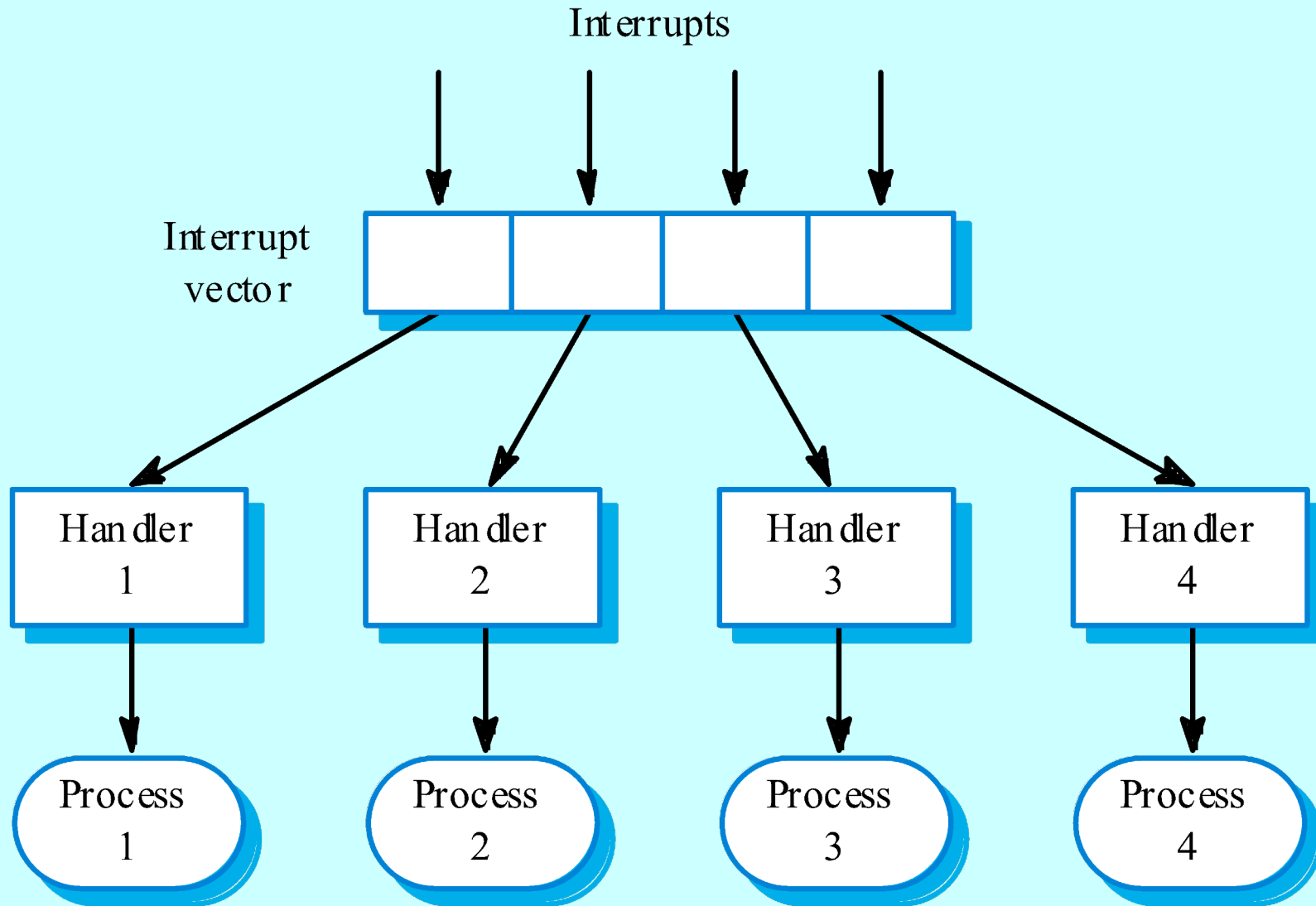
Selective broadcasting



Interrupt-driven systems

- *Used in real-time systems* where *fast response to an event is essential*.
- There are known *interrupt types with a handler* defined for each type.
- Each type is associated with *a memory location and a hardware switch causes transfer to its handler*.
- Allows *fast response but complex to program and difficult to validate*.

Interrupt-driven control



Distributed System Design

Distributed systems

- Virtually all large computer-based systems are now distributed systems.
- Information processing is *distributed over several computers* rather than confined to a single machine.
- *Distributed software engineering* is therefore very important for enterprise computing systems.

Distributed system characteristics

- ***Resource sharing***
 - Sharing of hardware and software resources.
- ***Openness***
 - Use of equipment and software from different vendors.
- ***Concurrency***
 - Concurrent processing to enhance performance.
- ***Scalability***
 - Increased throughput by adding new resources.
- ***Fault tolerance***
 - The ability to continue in operation after a fault has occurred.

Distributed system disadvantages

- *Complexity*
 - Typically, *distributed systems are more complex* than centralised systems.
- *Security*
 - *More susceptible* to external attack.
- *Manageability*
 - *More effort required* for system management.
- *Unpredictability*
 - Unpredictable responses depending on the system organisation and *network load*.

Distributed systems architectures

- *Client-server architectures*
 - *Distributed services*
 - provided by *servers*
 - requested and used by *clients*.
- *Distributed object architectures*
 - *No distinction between clients and servers.*

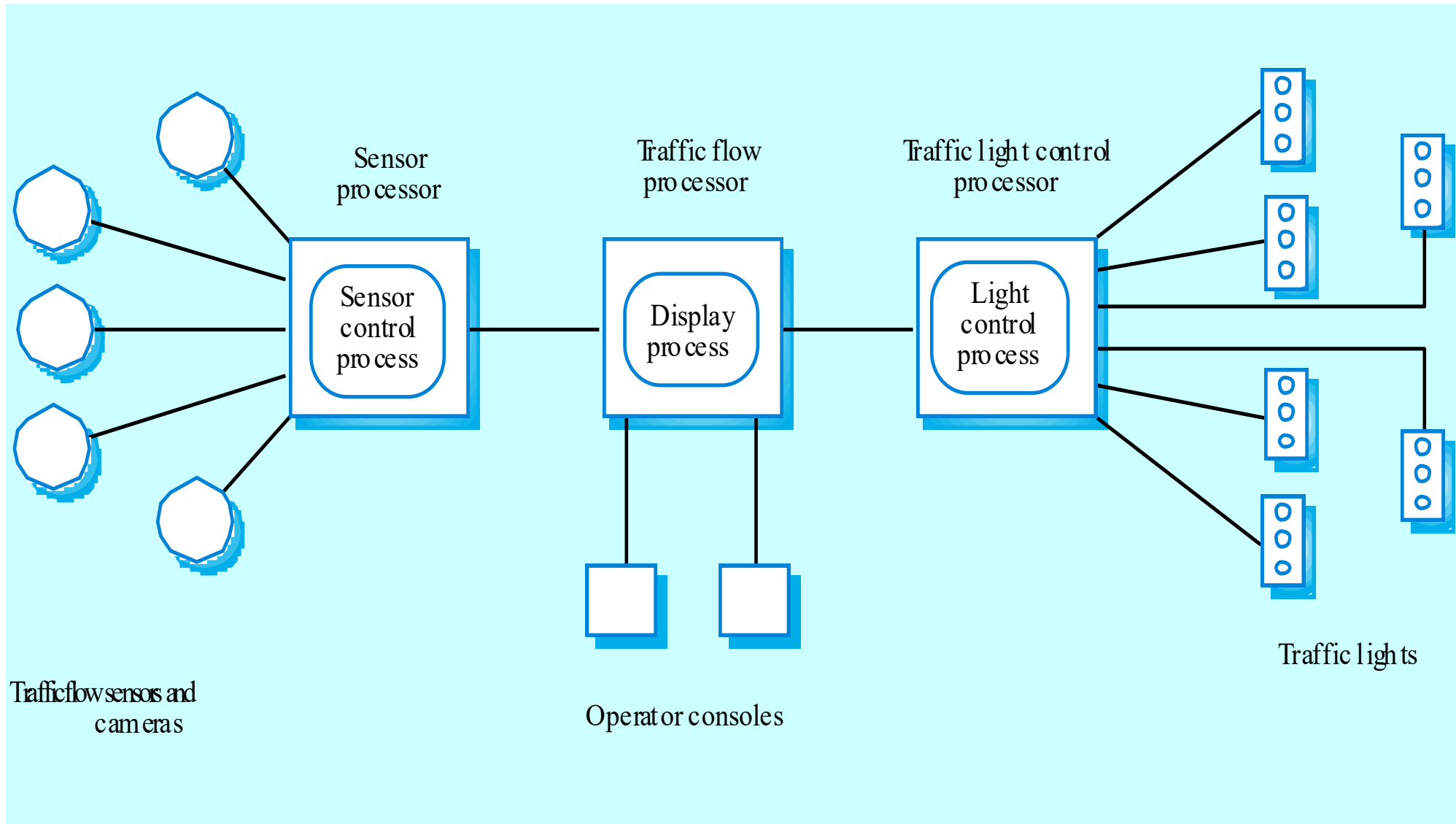
Middleware

- *Software that manages and supports the different components of a distributed system.* In essence, it sits in the *middle* of the system.
- Middleware is usually *off-the-shelf* rather than specially written software.
- Examples
 - Transaction processing monitors;
 - Data converters;
 - Communication controllers.

Multiprocessor architectures

- *Simplest distributed system* model.
- System composed of *multiple processes* which may (but need not) *execute on different processors*.
- Architectural model of many *large real-time systems*.
- *Process to processor distribution*
 - either *pre-ordered*
 - or under the control of a *dispatcher*.

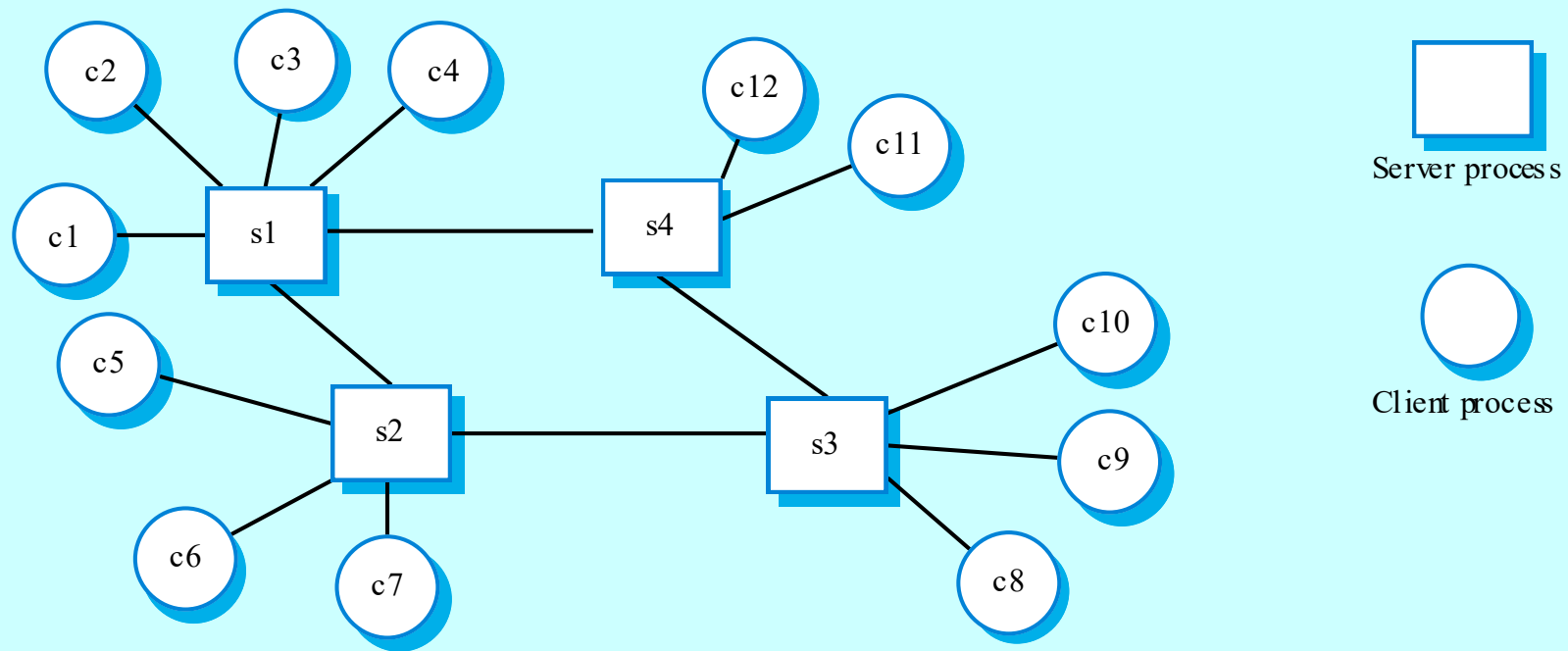
A multiprocessor traffic control system



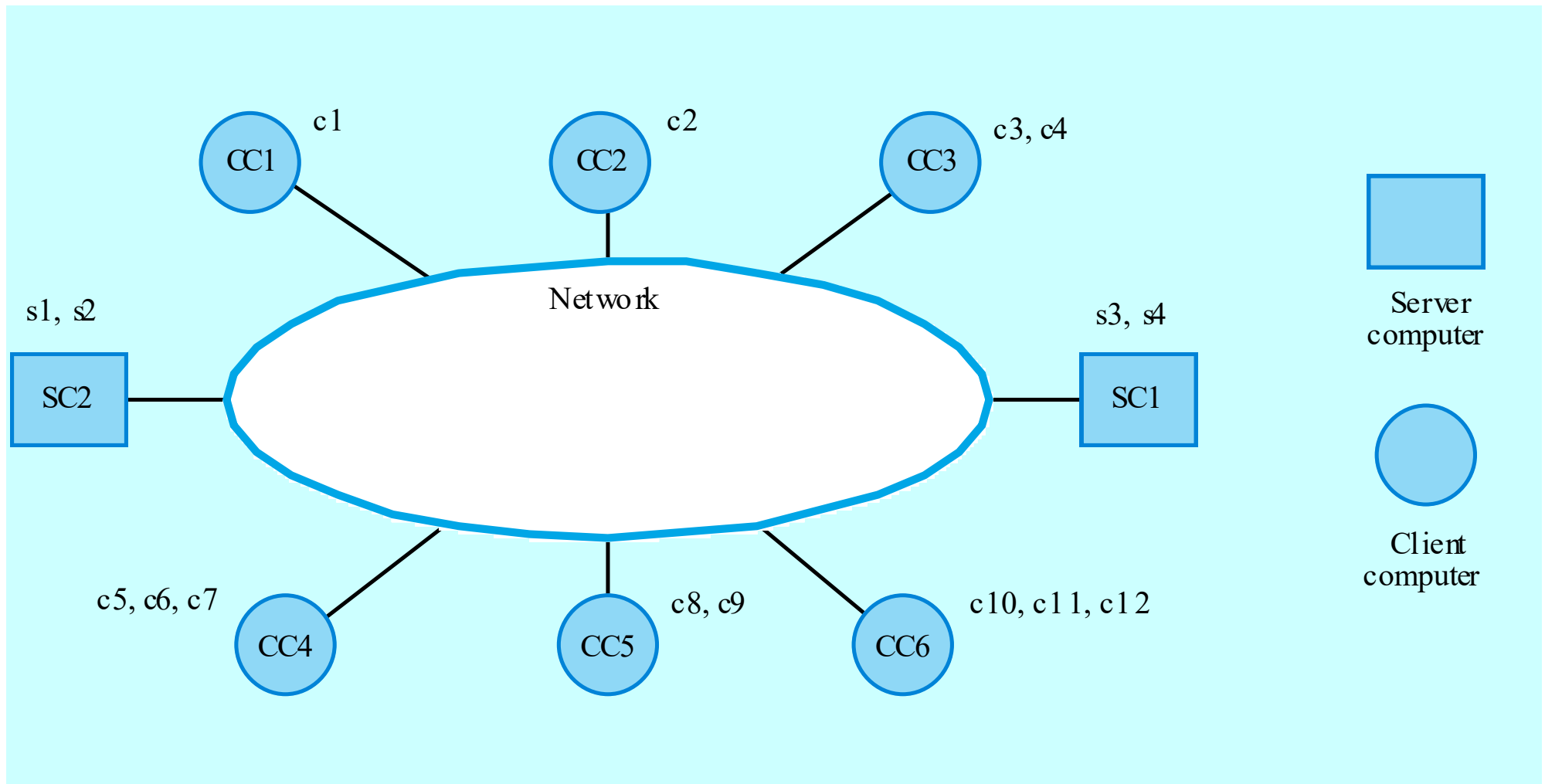
Client-server architectures

- The application is modelled as a set of services that are provided by servers and a set of clients that use these services.
- Clients know of servers but servers need not know of clients.
- Clients and servers are logical processes
- The mapping of processors to processes is not necessarily 1 : 1.

A client-server system



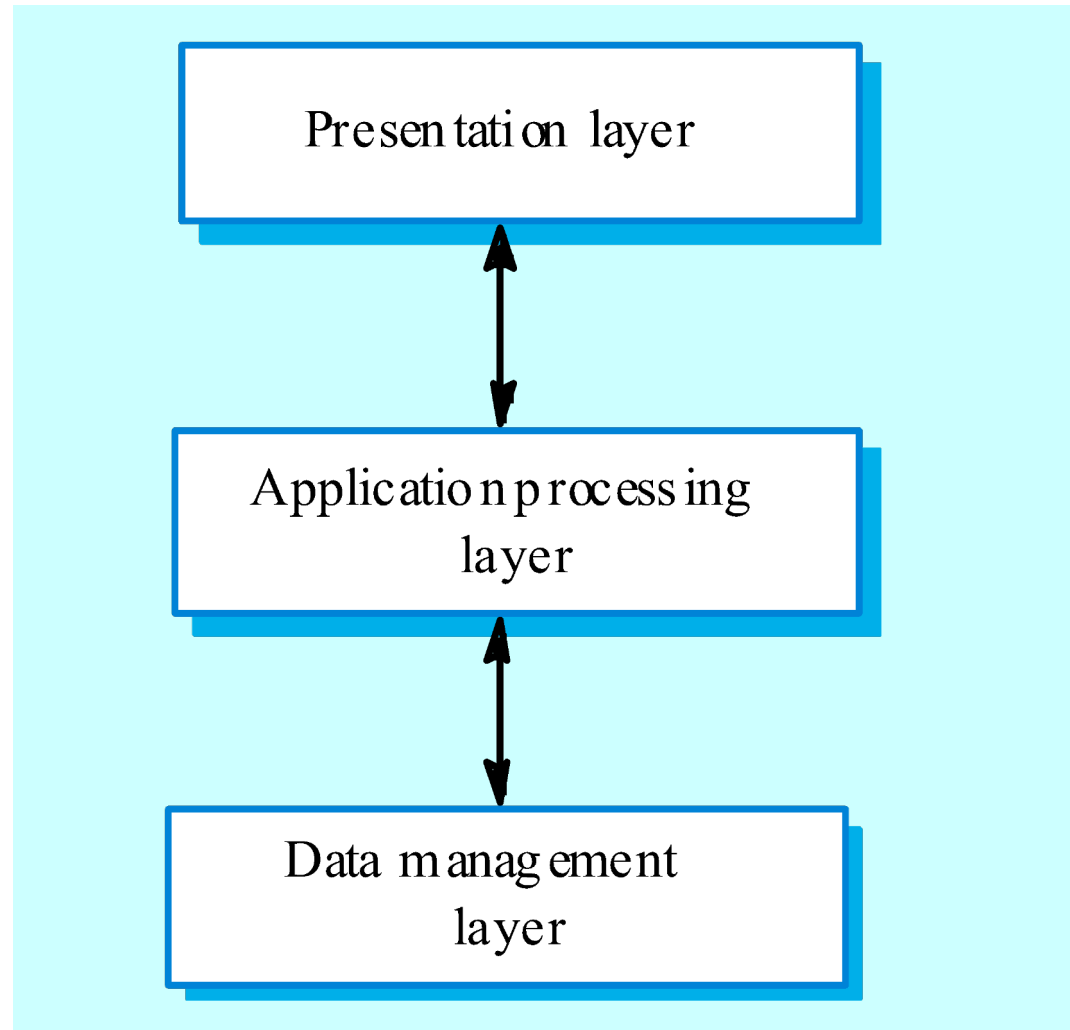
Computers in a C/S network



Layered application architecture

- ***Presentation layer***
 - *presenting the results of a computation* to users and
 - *collecting user inputs.*
- ***Application processing layer***
 - *providing application specific functionality* e.g., in a banking system, banking functions such as open account, close account, etc.
- ***Data management layer***
 - *managing the system databases.*

Application layers



Thin and fat clients

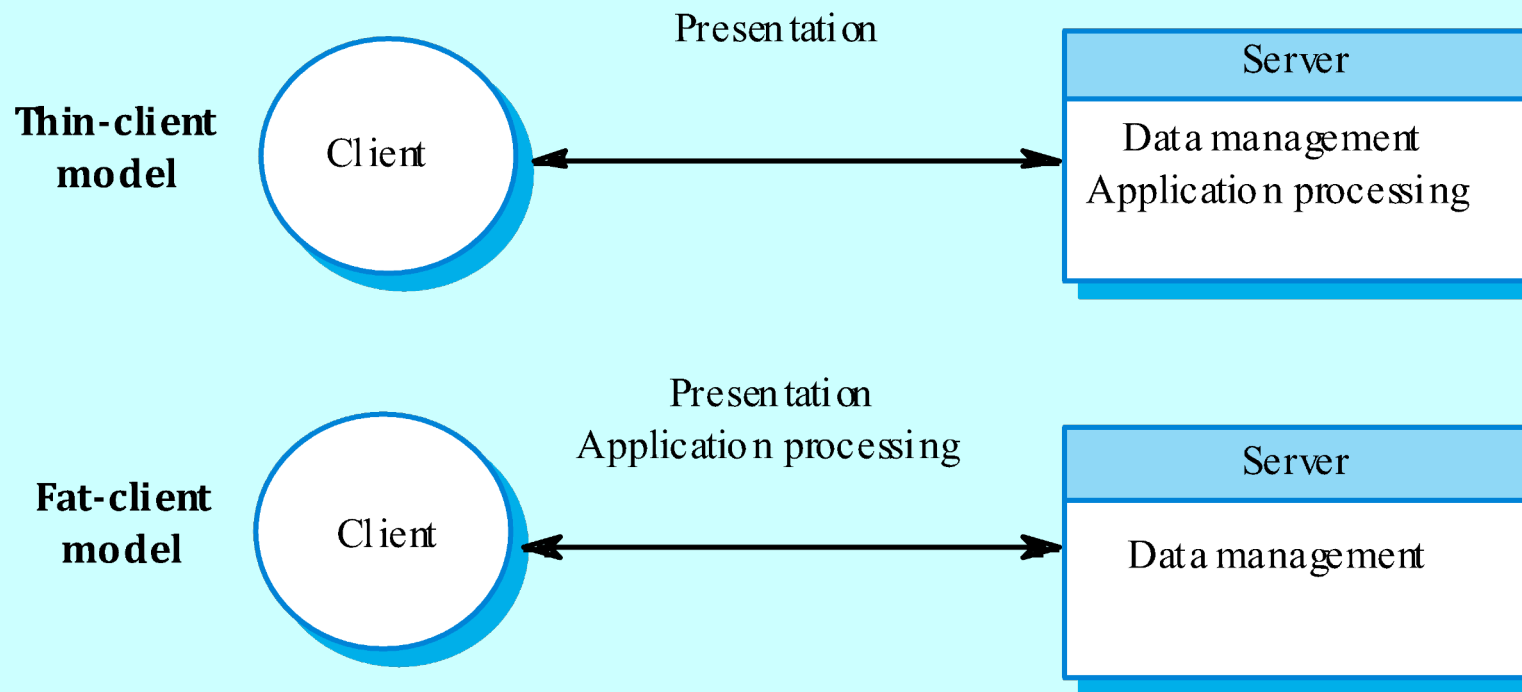
- ***Thin-client model***

- *Application processing and data management is on the server.*
- *Client simply responsible for running presentation software.*

- ***Fat-client model***

- *Server only responsible for data management.*
- *Client realizes application logic and interactions with the system user.*

Thin and fat clients



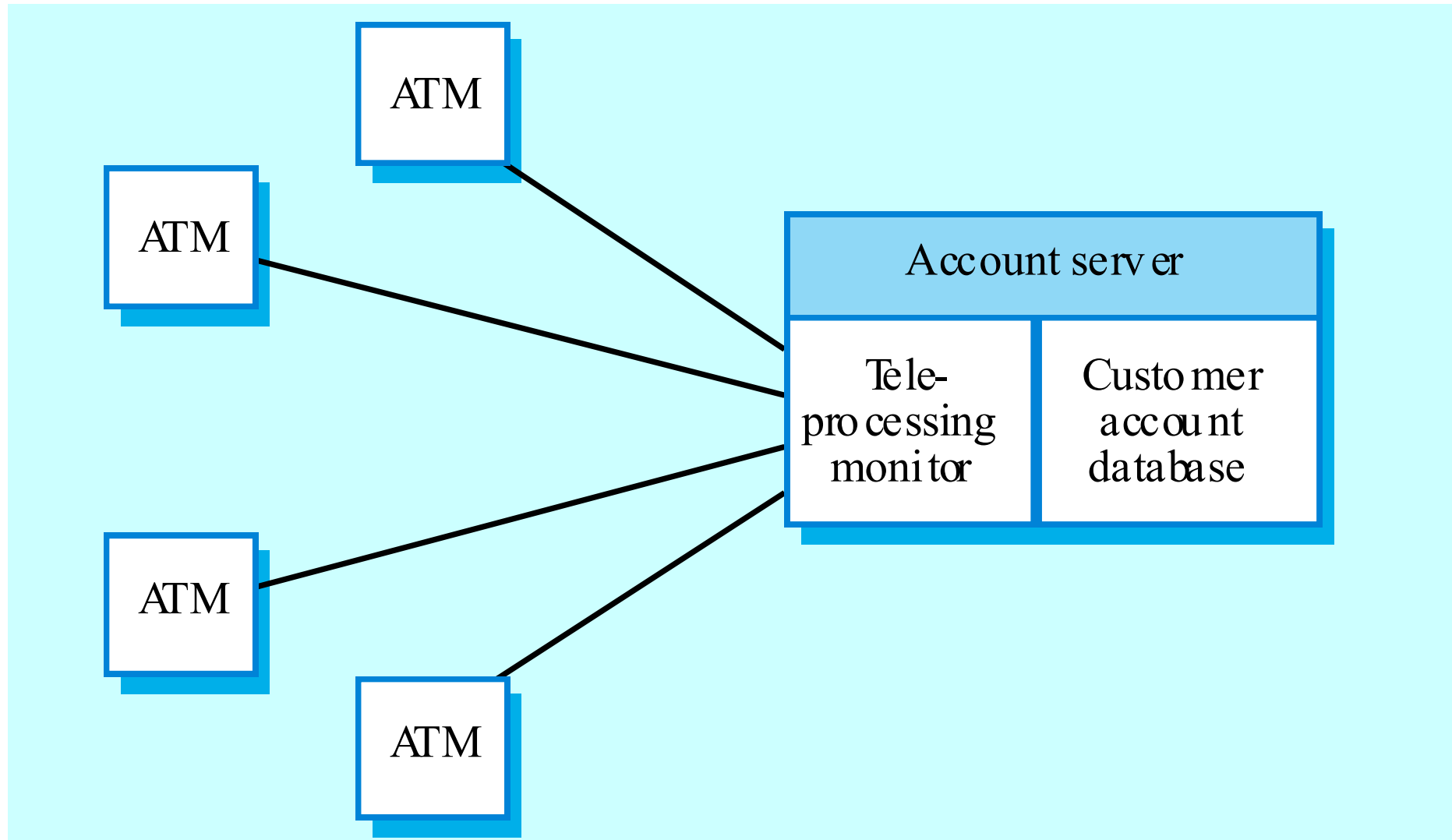
Thin client model

- Used when *legacy (i.e., old) systems* are migrated to client/server architectures.
 - The legacy system acts as a server in its own right with a graphical interface implemented on a client.
- A major disadvantage is that it places a *heavy processing load on both the server and the network.*

Fat client model

- More processing is delegated to the client as the application processing is locally executed.
- Most suitable for new C/S systems where the capabilities of the client system are known in advance.
- More complex than a thin client model especially for management. New versions of the application have to be installed on all clients.

A client-server ATM system



Quiz 1 - 7/5/2025 (5 minutes)

Do not forget your: Name+Surname, Student ID, Signature, Date

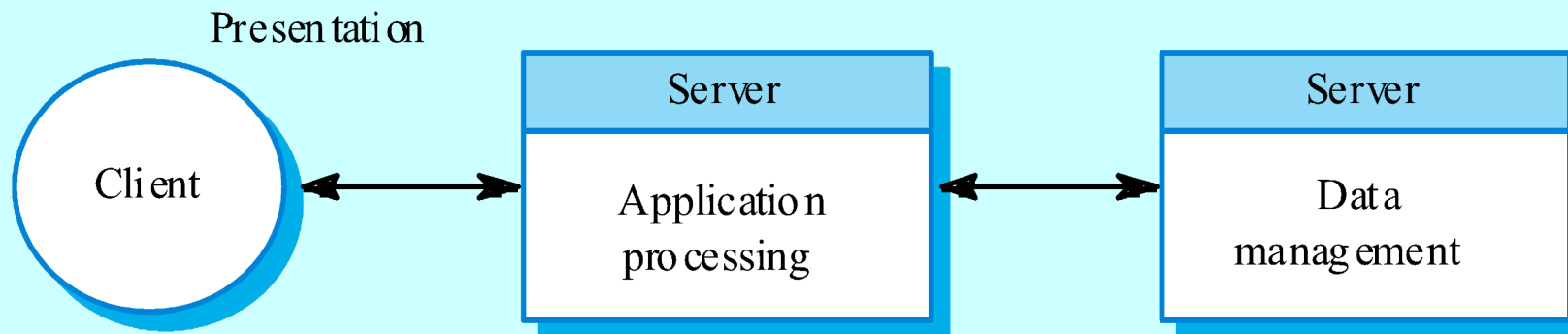
Do not write the questions!

1. How are the three layers distributed in a thin client architecture?
2. How are the three layers distributed in a fat client architecture?
3. Are these three layers HW or SW layers?
4. How many computers must exist to have such a C/S architecture work?

Three-tier architectures

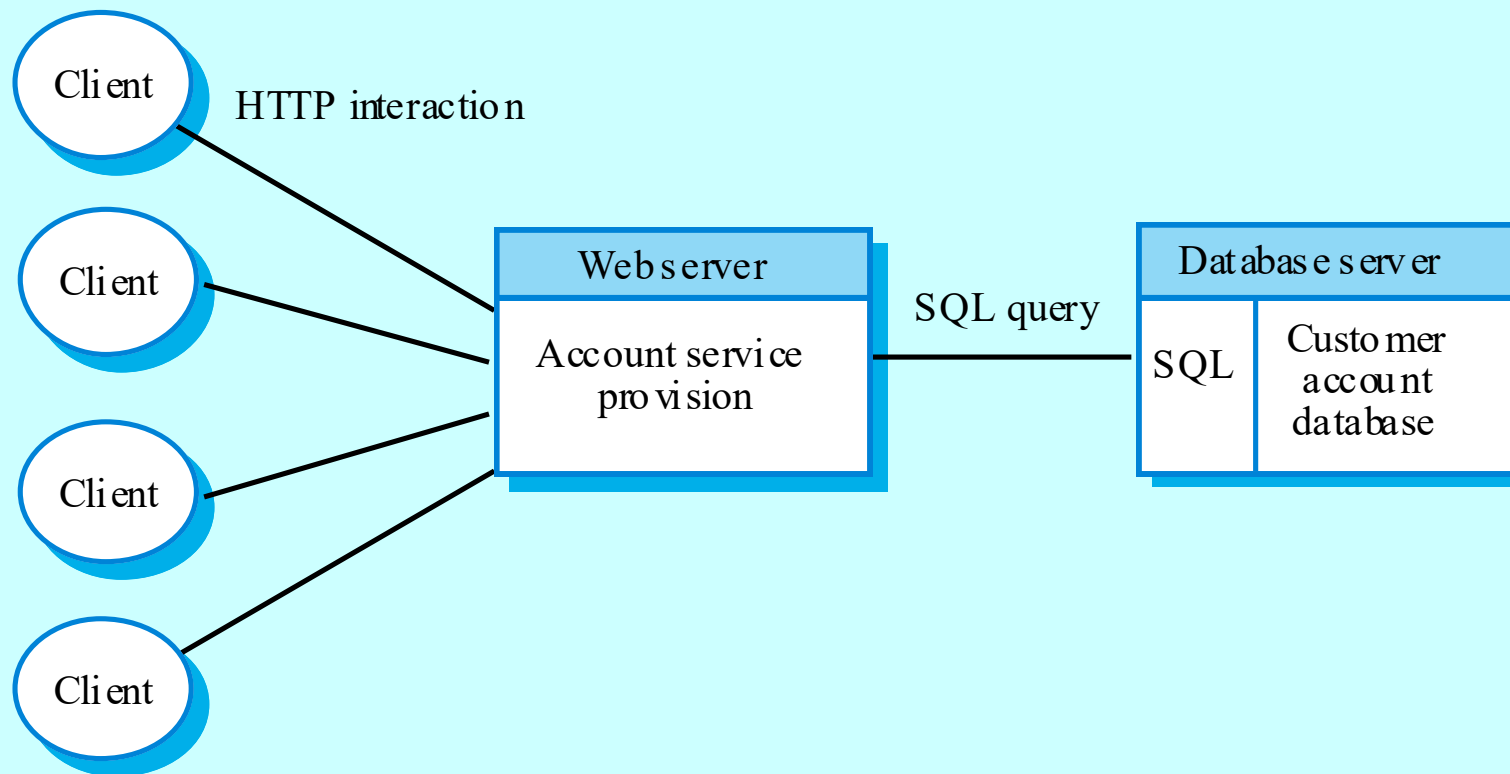
- In a three-tier architecture, each of the application architecture *layers may execute on a separate processor.*
- Allows for *better performance than a thin-client approach* and is simpler to manage than a fat-client approach.
- A *more scalable architecture* - as demands increase, extra servers can be added.

A 3-tier C/S architecture



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An internet banking system



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Use of C/S architectures

Architecture	Applications
Two-tier C/S architecture with thin clients	Legacy system applications where separating application processing and data management is impractical. Computationally-intensive applications such as compilers with little or no data management. Data-intensive applications (browsing and querying) with little or no application processing.
Two-tier C/S architecture with fat clients	Applications where application processing is provided by off-the-shelf software (e.g. Microsoft Excel) on the client. Applications where computationally-intensive processing of data (e.g. data visualisation) is required. Applications with relatively stable end-user functionality used in an environment with well-established system management.
Three-tier or multi-tier C/S architecture	Large scale applications with hundreds or thousands of clients Applications where both the data and the application are volatile. Applications where data from multiple sources are integrated.

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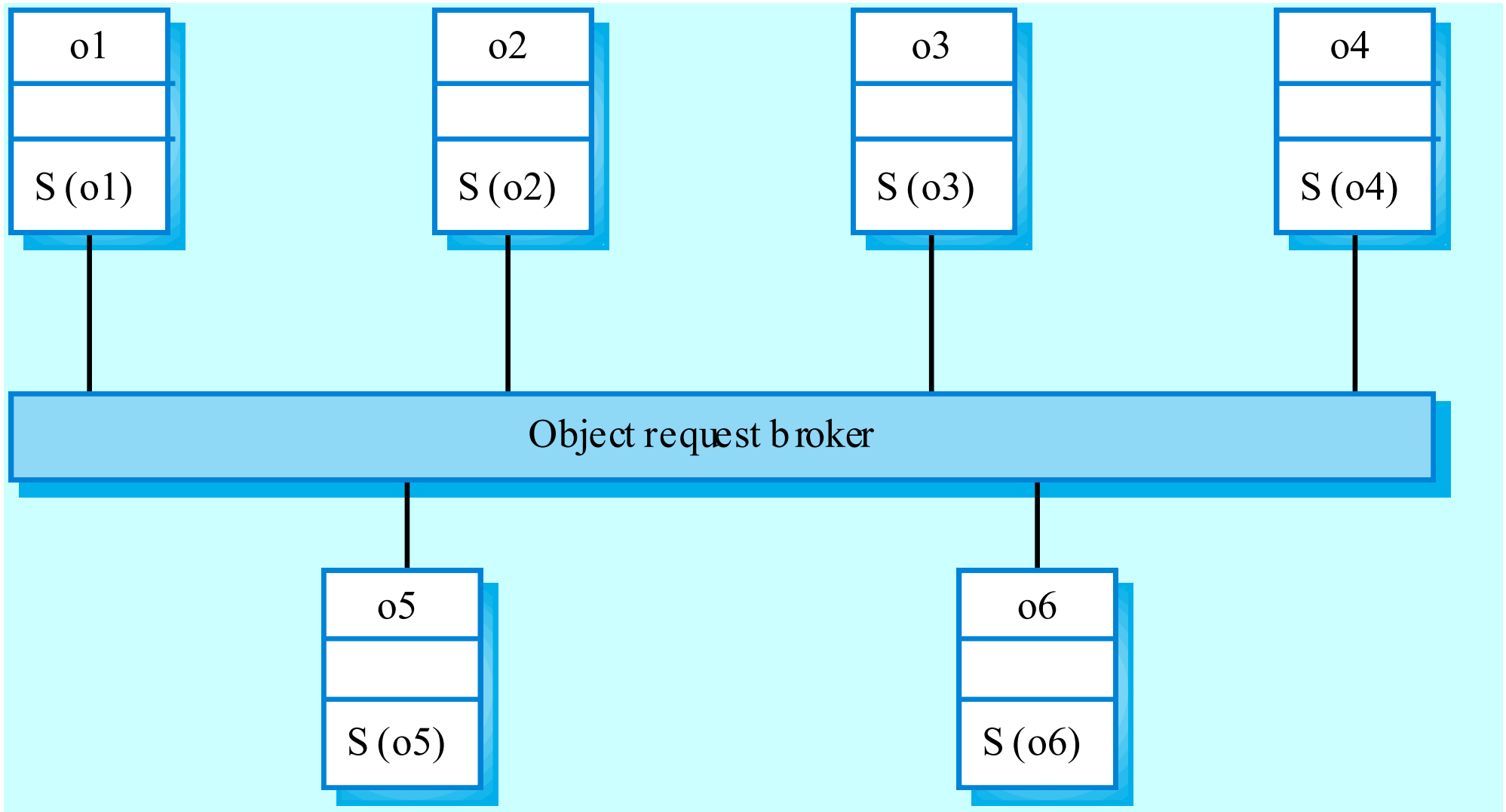
Some remarks for previous slide

- **Thin client:** the reason for the impracticality of separating APL and DML is the missing encapsulation of processing from data management. That is, since they are built together as a single module, to separate them would mean too much communication overhead between APL and DML that this would put a huge load on the network.
- **Fat client:** off-the-shelf processing layers are most likely subject to upgrades (i.e., changes) which is more secure to let have them get automatically upgraded at client rather than at server. Computationally-intensive processing of data requires frequent access to current data which makes current data available at client and its processing be handled at the same site.

Distributed object architectures

- There is ***no distinction*** in a distributed object architectures between clients and servers.
- Each distributable entity is ***an object*** that provides ***services to other objects and receives services from other objects.***
- Object ***communication is through a middleware*** system called an ***object request broker.***
- However, ***distributed object architectures are more complex to design than C/S systems.***

Distributed object architecture



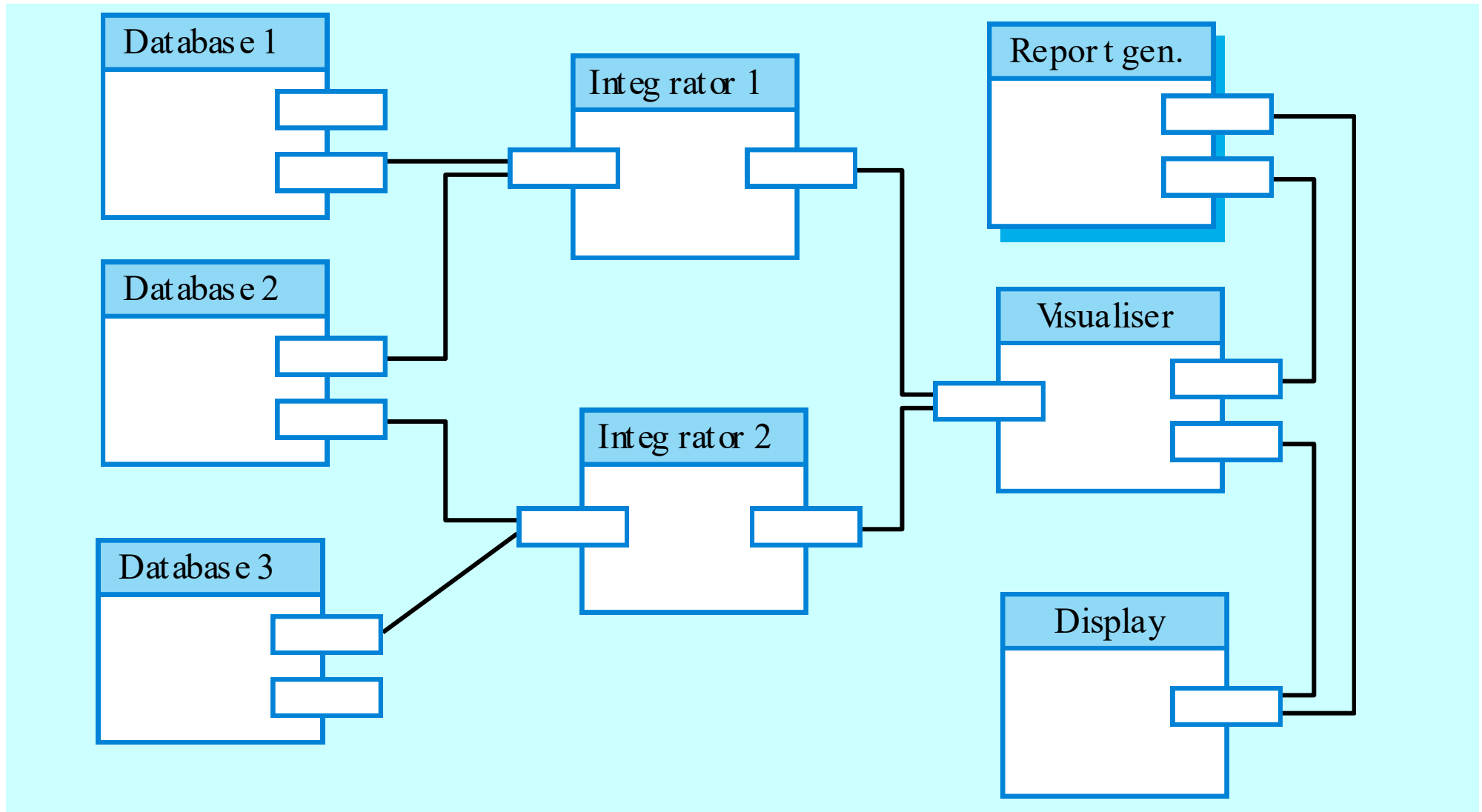
Advantages of distributed object architecture

- It allows the system designer to *delay decisions on where and how services should be provided*.
- It is a very *open system architecture* that allows new resources to be added to it as required.
- The system is *flexible and scaleable*.
- It is *possible to reconfigure the system dynamically* with objects migrating across the network as required.

Uses of distributed object architecture

- As a logical model allowing to *structure and organise the system*. In this case, you think about how to *provide application functionality solely in terms of services and combinations of services*.
- As a *flexible approach to the implementation of client-server systems*. The logical model of the system is a client-server model but both clients and servers are realised as distributed objects communicating through a common communication framework.

A data mining system



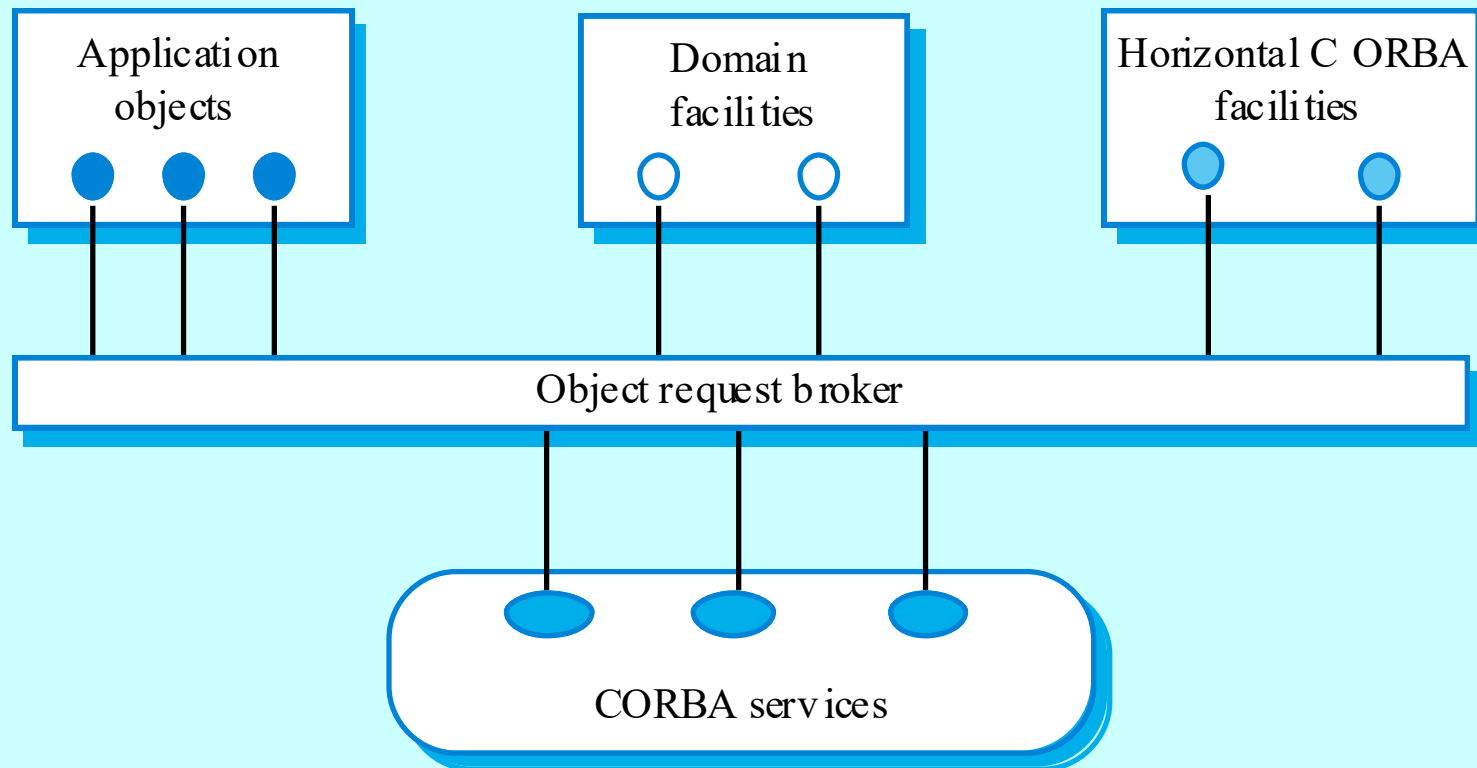
Data mining system

- The logical model of the system is not one of service provision where there are distinguished data management services.
- It allows the number of databases that are accessed to be increased without disrupting the system.
- It allows *new types of relationship* to be mined *by adding new integrator objects*.

CORBA

- CORBA: a *standard for an Object Request Broker*
- *middleware to manage communications between distributed objects.*
- Middleware for distributed computing is required at 2 levels:
 - At the logical communication level, the middleware allows objects on different computers to exchange data and control information;
 - At the component level, the middleware provides a basis for developing compatible components. CORBA component standards have been defined.

CORBA application structure



CORBA Services

- Domain-independent interfaces used by many distributed object programs.
- Example: a service providing for the discovery of other available services; almost always necessary regardless of the application domain.
- **The Naming Service** -- which allows clients to find objects based on names;
- **The Trading Service** -- which allows clients to find objects based on their properties.

CORBA Common Facilities

- **Horizontally-oriented** (i.e., common to many application domain), but unlike object services they are oriented towards end-user applications.
- Example: *Distributed Document Component Facility* (DDCF), a compound document Common Facility based on OpenDoc.
- DDCF allows for presentation and interchange of objects based on a document model, for example, facilitating the linking of a spreadsheet object into a report document.

Peer-to-peer architectures

- Peer to peer (p2p) systems are *decentralised* systems where computations may be carried out by any node in the network.
- The overall system is designed to take advantage of the computational power and storage of a large number of networked computers.
- Most p2p systems have been personal systems but there is increasing business use of this technology.

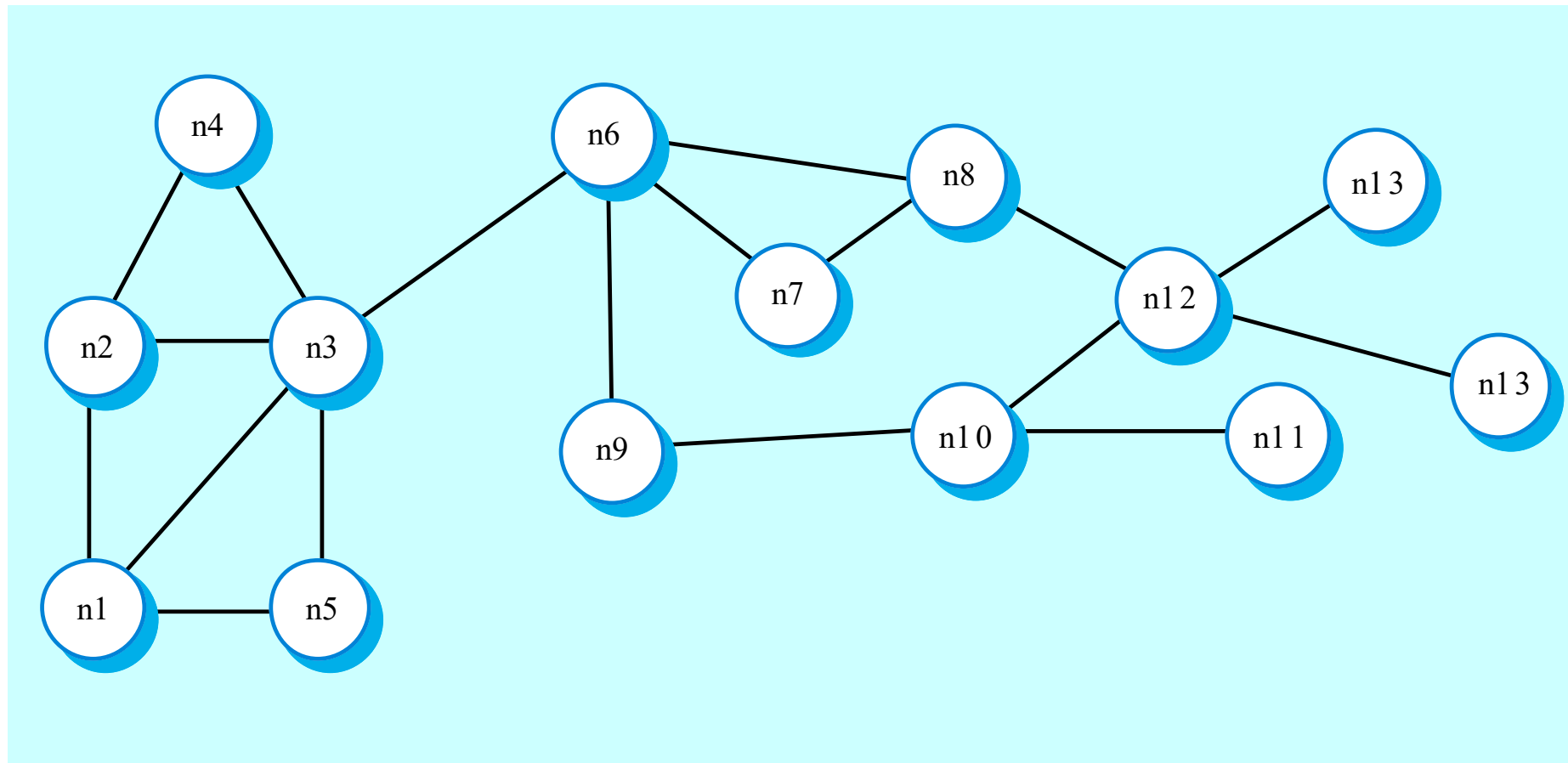
Examples to P2P architectures

- File sharing systems on PCs.
- Instant messaging systems such as ICQ to establish a direct communication between users.

P2p architectural models

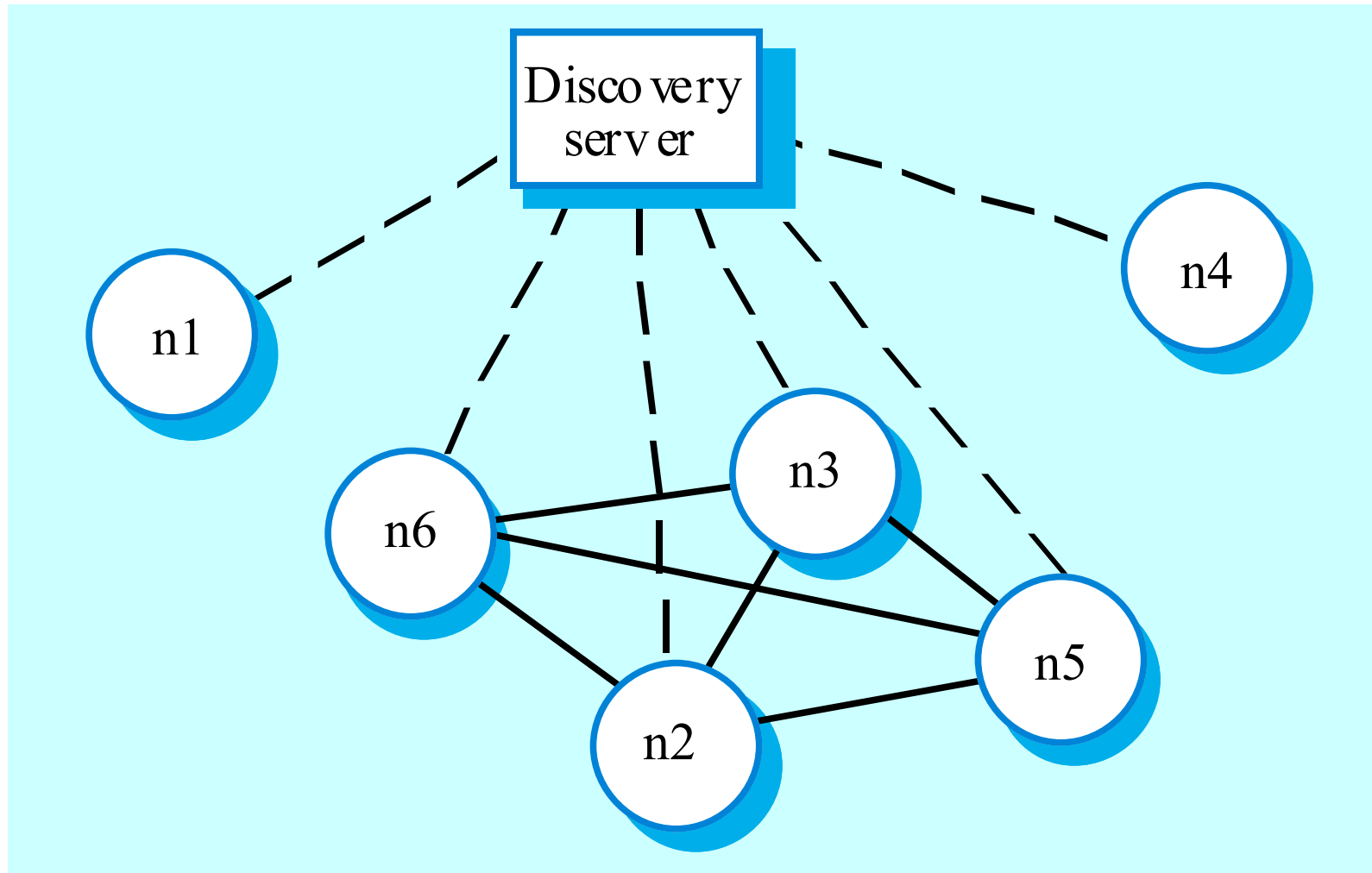
- The *logical network* architecture
 - *Decentralised* architectures;
 - *Semi-centralised* architectures.
- *Application* architecture
 - The generic organisation of components making up a p2p application.

Decentralised p2p architecture



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Semi-centralised p2p architecture



References

[1] Software Engineering, Ian Sommerville, 8th edition, Addison-Wesley, 2007